



REVITAL PRODUCTIONS

Data Studio Setup Guide

How to connect Data Studio to the third-party tools in your stack and build live analytics dashboards clients see inside their portal.

ABOUT THIS DOCUMENT

What This Covers

Data Studio is Google's free reporting and dashboard tool. This guide covers connecting it to the third-party marketing tools in the stack, building a client dashboard, and reusing that build across multiple clients without starting from scratch each time. Embedding the finished dashboard into a client's portal is not covered here — Client Portal Manager already has a dedicated “Live Analytics (Data Studio Embed)” field per client for that.

Cost: Data Studio itself is free at any scale — unlimited reports, no seat limits for the free tier. A \$9/user/month Data Studio Pro tier exists but only adds team version history and admin controls, not needed yet. The only cost that shows up is on the connector side, covered next.

CONNECTOR LANDSCAPE

Native vs. Partner Connectors

Google's own products connect for free with no extra software. Everything outside the Google ecosystem needs a partner connector — a small piece of paid or freemium software that bridges that platform's data into Data Studio.

Data Source	Connector Type	Cost	Notes
Google Analytics 4	Native	Free	Add data → pick GA4 → select the property. ~30 seconds.
Google Ads	Native	Free	Same flow as GA4 — select the specific Ads account.
Google Search Console	Native	Free	Same flow, if/when needed.
YouTube Analytics	Native	Free	Worth including given the AV/production side — video views, watch time, and engagement, same instant native connect as GA4.

Data Source	Connector Type	Cost	Notes
Meta Ads (Facebook + Instagram)	Partner	Free tier available*	Porter Metrics has a genuinely free tier at low volume — try before paying.
TikTok Ads	Partner	Free tier available*	Same — Porter Metrics free tier covers light use.
Google Business Profile	Partner	\$20–200/mo	No native connector despite being a Google product. Relevant for the Local SEO service line — ratings, reviews, search/map views.

Data Source	Connector Type	Cost	Notes
HubSpot	Partner	\$20–200/mo	No free tier found; only needed once a real HubSpot account is in use.
Klaviyo	Partner	\$20–200/mo	Same — only relevant once a real Klaviyo account exists.
Sprout Social	Partner	\$20–200/mo	Same.

*Common partner connector brands: Porter Metrics, Supermetrics, Windsor.ai, Dataslayer, Coupler.io. Pricing and free-tier limits vary and change over time — check current terms before committing to one.

Showing revenue the work actually generated: Don't connect Stripe for this — that's Revital's own payment collection (what the client pays Revital), not revenue their business earned because of the work, and it doesn't belong on a client's portal. The right number lives in data already connected: GA4's revenue-by-channel reporting (if the client's site tracks purchases/leads as conversions) attributes dollar value to the specific channel that drove it, and Google Ads / Meta Ads both report their own Conversion Value and ROAS natively once conversion tracking is set up. No extra connector needed — just build the chart against the conversion/revenue fields already available on the GA4 and ad platform data sources.

REPORT LAYOUT

Recommended Report Layout

This is the layout to build once as the template — every section below reuses the same position and styling across every client copy, so reports look identical regardless of which client is looking at theirs.

Section	What It Shows	Notes
Header row	Client name/logo + date range control	Only the logo changes per client copy
KPI scorecards (4)	Sessions, Conversions, Conversion value, ROAS	Keep to 4 numbers — the ones a client actually cares about
Trend chart	Sessions + Conversions over time (dual axis)	Shows direction before channel-level detail
Channel breakdown	Sessions by channel + Revenue by channel, side by side	Prevents volume and value getting confused with each other
Campaign table	Spend / Conversions / ROAS per campaign	Optional — only for clients running enough distinct campaigns to need it

SETUP PROCESS

Building the Template Report

Since each client has their own separate GA4 property and ad accounts (not one shared agency account), the fastest path is: build the report once as a template using a real client's data, then copy it per client and swap in that client's own accounts. Building it in this order is what keeps every client copy looking the same.

1 Connect the first client's data sources

Go to datastudio.google.com and sign in. Start a blank report. In the connector search, pick the top result named plainly “Google Analytics” by Google — that's the native, free connector and it covers GA4 properties despite the name. Skip any “Google Analytics 4” card from a partner (e.g. Supermetrics) further down the list — those are paid and duplicate what the native one already does for free. Same logic for Google Ads: use the native connector, not a partner one.

2 Set the report theme first

Theme and layout (paint roller icon) → keep it plain so it doesn't compete with the client's own branding. Font: Data Studio's default Roboto (custom uploaded font files aren't supported — the theme editor only offers its built-in list of ~40 fonts). Background: white or a very light neutral gray. Border: none, or a hairline light gray around chart edges only. Save the Revital orange accent for the trend-chart line and bar-chart fills, not the page background.

3 Build the header row

Add a text box for the client name and a date range control (Insert → Date range control) side by side at the top. For the logo, use Insert → Image and upload the client's logo file — a transparent-background PNG sits cleaner than a white-boxed one. Match the logo's height to the header text box. Every future copy keeps this exact position; only the logo image changes per client.

4 Add the KPI scorecards

Insert → Scorecard, four times, placed in a row. Field picks: **Sessions**; **Key events** (GA4 renamed “Conversions” to “Key events” in 2024-25 — same metric, new name; if the old name still shows, reconnect the data source to refresh its fields); **Total revenue** for conversion value, or **Key event value** if this client's key events carry a value but aren't ecommerce purchases. Turn off “Compare to” under Style unless period-over-period comparison is wanted. Select all four and use Arrange → Align → Distribute horizontally so spacing is even.

ROAS has no single field to pick. GA4 doesn't know ad spend — that data lives in Google Ads/Meta, not GA4 — so there's no native “ROAS” field in the GA4 connector. If this client only runs Google Ads, add the Google Ads connector as its own data source and use its built-in **Conv. value / cost** field for the ROAS scorecard instead. For true blended ROAS across multiple ad platforms, blend GA4's Total revenue with each platform's cost field and build a calculated field: $\text{SUM}(\text{Total revenue}) / \text{SUM}(\text{Cost})$. That's more setup than a single field pick — only worth it if the client runs paid ads on more than one platform.

5 Add the trend chart

Insert → Time series chart, dimension Date, metrics Sessions + Key events. Since the two are on very different scales, click the Key events metric in the Setup panel and set it to the right axis — otherwise it flattens near zero against Sessions. This is the one chart worth spending time getting right, since it's reused unchanged across every client.

6 Add the channel breakdown

Two charts side by side. Left: Insert → Bar chart, Dimension **Session default channel group** (GA4's built-in grouping — Organic Search, Paid Search, Paid Social, Direct, Email, etc. — no manual grouping needed), Metric Sessions, sorted descending. Right: another Bar chart or Table, same dimension, Metric Total revenue (or Key events if this client has no revenue tracking set up — check Reports → Monetization in their GA4 first). Give each channel the same color in both charts (Style tab → per-dimension-value color) so a channel reads consistently across both.

7 Add the campaign table (optional per client)

Insert → Table, dimension Campaign, metrics Spend/Key events/ROAS. Since this section is optional, group it (select all its elements, right-click → Group) so it can be deleted as one unit for clients who don't need it, without disturbing anything above it.

8 Lock in consistency before copying

Select every element (Ctrl/Cmd+A) and check Arrange → Align to confirm nothing is off-grid. This is the version that becomes the template.

9 Enable embedding and sharing

File → Embed report → check “Enable embedding.” Then use the Share button (top right) to set access to “Anyone with the link can view.” This is what lets it load as an iframe with no client login required.

10 Copy the report for each additional client

File → Make a copy. Data Studio will ask which data source to use for the copy — this is the key step. Point each data source to the new client's own GA4 property / ad account / platform account instead of reusing the original client's. The layout, charts, and filters carry over automatically since they're built on the same field names.

11 Repeat embedding on each copy

Embedding settings do not carry over automatically when you copy a report — repeat step 9 (enable embedding, set sharing) on every copy, then grab that copy's own embed URL for that client's portal.

Field Name Quick Reference

Old / Expected Name	Current Field to Use	Note
Conversions	Key events	GA4 renamed this in 2024-25. Reconnect the data source if the old name still shows.
Conversion value	Total revenue / Key event value	Total revenue for ecommerce purchases; Key event value if the key event carries a value but isn't a purchase.
Channel	Session default channel group	Built-in GA4 dimension — buckets traffic automatically, no manual grouping needed.
ROAS	No native field — build it	Use Google Ads' Conv. value / cost, or blend GA4 revenue with ad platform cost.
GA4 native connector	“Google Analytics” by Google	Top search result, plain name, free. Skip any “Google Analytics 4” partner card.

Good to know for later: Data Studio added component visibility controls in early 2026, letting a single shared report show clients performance numbers while hiding internal margin/markup data from the same view for your own team. Not needed with the copy-per-client approach above, but useful if reporting ever consolidates to one shared agency-wide dashboard instead of separate copies.

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Connector pricing and free-tier availability change over time - re-check current terms before committing to a paid partner connector.